PDF Viewer Native

A free, open-source PDF viewer and editor for Windows, Android and the web, with its own PDF engine and no telemetry.

SAMPLE DOCUMENT

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Open source under the MIT licence • No telemetry • No account

This document was made with the PDF engine of PDF Viewer Native.

OVERVIEW

Features at a glance

One app to read, search, comment on, fill in, sign, edit and convert PDF files. The full list, with a user guide, is in docs/features.md of the source repository.

View

- Continuous, single-page and facing views
- Zoom from 25 % to 1600 %, sharp at every zoom
- Tabs, bookmarks, thumbnails, night mode and full screen

Read

- Read mode for screen readers, in tagged reading order
- Read Aloud and a PDF/UA-1 accessibility check
- Make Accessible adds tags to untagged files

Select and search

- Word-processor text selection
- Search with a list of results
- OCR for scanned pages, on this computer

Comment and measure

- Highlights, notes, ink and shapes
- Distance, perimeter and area measuring
- Standard, dynamic and custom stamps

Edit

- Text and images in place
- Organise, merge and split pages
- Headers, footers, watermarks, Bates numbers
- Reduce file size and compare documents

Forms, signatures, security

- Fill and flatten forms
- Sign (PAdES-B-LT and B-LTA) and verify
- AES-256 passwords and true redaction

Create and convert

- PDF from images, a scanner or Office files
- PDF/A
- Export to Word, Excel, PowerPoint, text and images

Print production

- Print with a live preview
- Output Preview: separations, overprint, total ink
- Preflight

Privacy and safety

- No script engine: active content never runs
- Save Clean Copy removes scripts and attachments
- No telemetry, no account, no cloud

One engine, three platforms

- Windows app drawn with Direct2D
- Web demo that runs in the browser tab
- Android app (preview) with the same engine

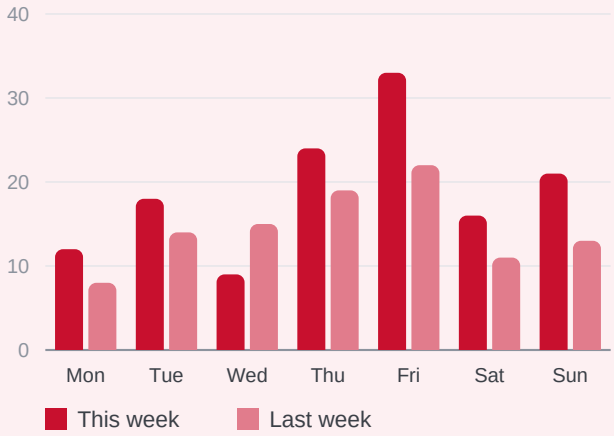
VECTOR GRAPHICS

Charts and shapes

Everything on this page is drawn with paths, not pictures. Zoom in as far as you like: the edges, curves and text stay sharp.

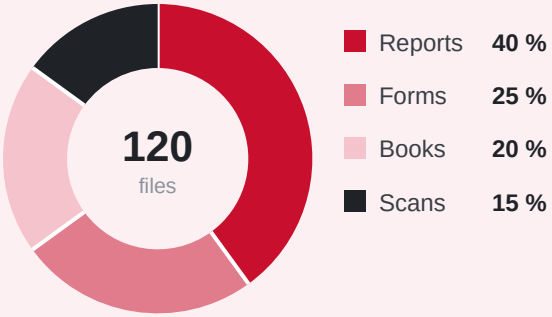
Pages read per day

Sample data for this demonstration

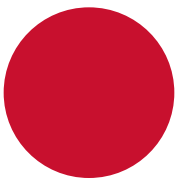


Documents opened

Sample data for this demonstration



Shapes, curves and fills

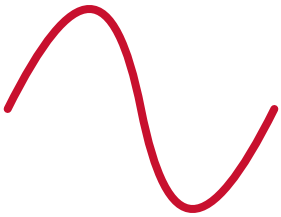


Circle

Rounded rectangle

Triangle

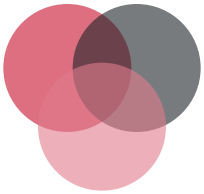
Star



Bezier curve

Dashed line and arrow

Gradient



Transparency

TABLE

Keyboard shortcuts

A selection of the shortcuts of the Windows app. The full table is in docs/features.md of the source repository.

Shortcut	When	Action
Ctrl+O	Always	Open a PDF
Ctrl+S	Document open	Save the document with its annotations
Ctrl+P	Document open	Print, with preview
Ctrl+F	Document open	Show or hide the search bar
F3 / Shift+F3	Search active	Next / previous match
Ctrl+C	Text selected	Copy the selected text
Ctrl+Z / Ctrl+Y	Document open	Undo / redo
Ctrl+D	Document open	Document properties
Ctrl+E	Document open	Edit text and images
Ctrl++ / Ctrl+-	Document open	Zoom in / out
Ctrl+0	Document open	Fit to page
Ctrl+1	Document open	Fit to width
Ctrl+R / Ctrl+Shift+R	Document open	Rotate the view clockwise / counter-clockwise
Ctrl+B	Always	Show or hide the sidebar
Ctrl+4	Document open	Read mode
Ctrl+Shift+N	Document open	Night mode (invert pages)
Ctrl+Tab / Ctrl+Shift+Tab	Several documents	Next / previous tab
Alt+Left / Alt+Right	Document open	Back / forward through jumps
F11	Document open	Full screen (Esc or F11 to exit)
Home / End	Document open	First / last page

The When column says when a shortcut works: always, while a document is open, or in the state it names.

INTERACTIVE FORM

Fill in a form

This page has a real form. Click a field and type, pick a value from a list or tick a box, then save the document to keep what you entered.

Reader survey (sample form)

Your name

Email address

Favourite feature

Select and search

How often do you read PDF files?

Every day

Comments

- [x] I use PDF Viewer Native on Windows
- [ ] I also use the web demo or the Android app

Good to know

- Nothing you type here is sent anywhere: the form has no script and no submit button.
- Flatten the form to turn the fields and their values into ordinary page content.
- The Android app (preview) uses the same engine and fills this form too.

TEXT

About PDF Viewer Native

PDF Viewer Native is a free, open-source PDF viewer and editor. It runs on Windows, in a web browser and, as a preview, on Android. Its source code is published under the MIT licence, so anyone can read it, build it and help to improve it.

Its own PDF engine

The app does not wrap another PDF library. Its engine, PdfEngine.Vector, is written in C# for .NET 9. The engine reads the file, interprets every page into a display list of paths, text and images, and gives that list to a renderer. On Windows, Direct2D draws the pages; in the browser and on Android, a portable Skia renderer draws the same display list. Because the pages are drawn from vectors, text and lines stay sharp from 25 % to 1600 % zoom.

A document is data, never a program

Many vulnerabilities of PDF viewers come from active content: JavaScript, launch actions and embedded files. The engine has no JavaScript interpreter. Active content is parsed, reported and left inert, and a link opens only when you click it. Every document is inspected when it opens, and Save Clean Copy writes a copy without scripts, launch actions and embedded files.

Private by design

Nothing about you or your documents is recorded or sent. There is no telemetry, no account and no cloud storage. The update check stays off until you allow it, and optional components are downloaded only when you ask for them.

Readable by everyone

Read mode follows the reading order of tagged PDF files and works with screen readers. Read Aloud speaks the text, the PDF/UA-1 check reports accessibility problems, and Make Accessible adds tags to a document that has none.

Try it

Press Ctrl+F and search for the word “engine”. The results list shows every match in this document.

ANNOTATIONS

Comments and markup

The notes below carry four comments made with the annotation tools: a highlight, a sticky note, a rectangle and an ellipse. They are ordinary PDF annotations, so other PDF readers show them too.

Meeting notes (sample)

The team reviewed the sample document on Thursday. Its seven pages cover the main features, a chart, a table, a form, a page of running text and this page of comments.

Action: check every page at 400 % zoom before the screenshots are taken. Text, charts and the icon must stay sharp.

Figure 1 shows the plan of the chart page. The rectangle marks the part to check first.

Figure 1 The chart page, in outline

Work with the comments

- Click a comment to select it, then drag it or its handles to move or resize it.
- Double-click it, or press Enter, to edit its note. Arrow keys nudge it by 1 pt (Shift: 10 pt).
- Press Delete to remove it, and Ctrl+Z to bring it back.